

04 IMPORTANCE OF PREPARATION

The first step to being successful is preparing to be.

SEASON	WEEK	FOCUS	KEY PHRASE
1	4	HEALTHY HABITS	“Be unrealistic.”

SUMMARY

This practice teaches fighters that preparation is the foundation of success in boxing and in life. The coach opens a discussion about preparation, then guides fighters to build a personal checklist in their journals covering required gear and a personal routine. Intentions revisits the team SMART goal from last week. Training introduces the hooks (3 and 4), builds speed with rapid 1 · 2 · 3 shadow rounds, works the 1 · 2 · 3 and 1 · 2 · 3 · 4 combinations on the mitts, and finishes with a partner call-out round. The burnout is a five-station circuit.

MATERIALS

- Fighter’s Mindset journal
- Mitts & gloves
- Writing utensils
- Poster board with last week’s team SMART goal

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this practice, fighters will:

1. Discuss the importance of preparation, including bringing all required gear, as a foundation for success in boxing and life
2. Create a preparation checklist fighters can return to each practice

COACH MESSAGE

15 MIN

SAY

What’s the first step to being successful?

The first step to being successful is preparing to be successful. What do we need to be prepared at Fight Like A Girl? We need all the equipment that lets us work as hard as possible: water bottle, hand wraps, appropriate shoes, comfortable clothes. You wouldn’t show up to basketball without your shoes or a basketball.

ACTIVITY - PERSONAL PREPARATION CHECKLIST

IN JOURNALS

JRNL JOURNAL - WEEK 4**JOURNAL P. 8-9**

- MIDDLE SCHOOL** Build a personal preparation checklist, gear checklist, preparation routine, commitment pledge, and a short reflection.
- HIGH SCHOOL** In boxing you prepare before you step in the ring. What is a five-step routine you could run the night before or morning of a hard school day so you show up ready? Write it like a combination.

1 GEAR CHECKLIST

List all essential equipment required for every training session.

Prompt: do you bring a change of clothes? How do you get water?

2 PREPARATION ROUTINE

Describe a personal routine that supports consistency and readiness, for example, packing gear the night before.

Prompt: do you pack your belongings? Where do you put your things? Do you prepare them in the morning or the night before?

Ideas: set reminders, write down a schedule where you will see it, keep teammates accountable.

3 COMMITMENT PLEDGE

Fighters sign a personal pledge at the bottom of the journal page, committing to show up prepared, physically and mentally, for every session.

4 REFLECTION PROMPT

Fighters respond in their journals: "What will I do if I forget something?" This builds accountability and emotional regulation.

INTENTIONS**5 MIN**

Review the team SMART goal set last week before fighters share.

SAY JRNL Also in the fighter journals

Last week we set a goal as a team. Today's guiding question: how can you take steps toward that goal today during practice?

 TRAINING**30 MIN****HOOK TECHNIQUE (3 AND 4)** New skill

Watch the hook video, or explain the hooks yourself.

HOOK 3 · LEAD HAND

- Lead arm extends from the body at a 90-degree angle.
- Elbow at the same height as the shoulder.
- Lift the heel of the lead foot off the ground.
- Twist the body with weight on the lead foot.
- Return to boxing stance.

HOOK 4 · REAR HAND

- Rear arm extends from the body at a 90-degree angle, an “L” shape.
- Lift the rear foot off the ground.
- Twist the body in a similar motion to the cross.
- Return to boxing stance.

WATCH OUT

- Fighters should not load up the punch, the movement goes toward the target only.
- The arm does not move alone; the body twist moves the arm.
- Eyes never leave the opponent.

RAPID 1 · 2 · 3 SHADOW ROUNDS Speed

- Three 30-second rounds of shadow 1 · 2 · 3, 30 seconds rest between.
- Speed over power, hands return to the face every time.
- Call the start and end of each round.

MITT WORK · COMBINATIONS 3 rounds

- Tell fighters to adjust the mitt to the side, keeping mitts at eye level.
- **Round 1:** 3 · 4
- **Round 2:** 1 · 2 · 3
- **Round 3:** 1 · 2 · 3 · 4
- Boxer and mitt holder switch roles.

PARTNER CALL-OUT Reaction

- The mitt holder names the punch; the boxer throws it.
- Start with single numbers, then call two- and three-punch combinations.
- Mitt holders give one piece of feedback per round.
- Switch roles.

☐ **BURNOUT · STATION CIRCUIT**

7 MIN

- Five stations, 45 seconds each, straight through: jump rope, shadow box, mountain climbers, plank, fast feet.
- Call the switch. No rest between stations, the rest is the walk.
- Fighters who finish cheer on the ones still working.

☐ **SHOUT-OUTS**

3 MIN

Fighters share shout-outs, each ending with **snap clap**.